HR Analytics

KPI Reference Guide

Hire-to-Retire Analytics Project

16 KPIs across 4 Dashboards

Recruitment · Performance · Lifecycle · Pulse & Engagement

Data Analysis Project — 2026

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Dashboard 1

Recruitment & Talent Acquisition

4 KPIs in this dashboard

Average Days to Fill

WHAT IS IT	The average number of calendar days between a vacancy opening (Vacancy_Start_Date) and the candidate's Hire_Date across all filled positions.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Prolonged vacancies create productivity gaps, increase Cost of Vacancy, and signal bottlenecks in sourcing, screening, or offer processes. It is one of the most universally tracked recruitment efficiency metrics.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If above benchmark, investigate which pipeline stage takes longest. Prioritise sourcing channels with faster fill times. Consider pre-approved talent pools for high-frequency roles.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Industry benchmark: 30-45 days. Internal target: under 40 days. Flag any role exceeding 60 days for immediate pipeline review.**

Average Total Acquisition Cost

WHAT IS IT	The mean Total_Acquisition_Cost per hired candidate, combining Sourcing_Cost and Cost_of_Vacancy into a single per-hire spend figure.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Acquisition cost directly impacts HR budget efficiency. A high average signals over-reliance on expensive channels (e.g. agencies) or excessively long vacancies inflating opportunity costs.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Shift volume toward lower-cost channels (employee referrals, job boards) if agency spend dominates. Re-evaluate agency contracts if cost per hire exceeds 2x the job board average.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: under $5,000 per hire for mid-level roles. Agency hires typically run $10,000-$15,000 — acceptable only for senior or niche roles.**

Hire Rate (%)

WHAT IS IT	The percentage of total candidates in the recruitment pipeline who reached a 'Hired' pipeline status. Calculated as (Hired count / Total candidates) x 100.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	A low hire rate indicates pipeline inefficiency — too many candidates are screened, interviewed, or extended offers to, relative to actual conversions. It also flags sourcing quality issues if candidates consistently fail late-stage assessments.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If below 25%, audit sourcing channels for candidate quality. If screening-to-interview conversion is high but offer acceptance is low, review compensation benchmarking and offer timelines.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Healthy range: 25-40%. Below 20% warrants a sourcing quality review. Above 50% may suggest screening standards are too low.**

Average LQI of Hired Candidates

WHAT IS IT	The mean Labour Quality Index (LQI) score across candidates with a Hired status. LQI is a composite score of Skill_Score, Culture_Score, and Potential_Score weighted together.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	LQI measures the calibre of talent being converted. A declining LQI over time suggests the organisation is lowering quality standards to fill vacancies faster — a trade-off that increases downstream attrition and performance risk.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If LQI trends downward, revisit minimum score thresholds in the screening process. Cross-reference with sourcing channel to identify which channels consistently deliver higher-quality candidates.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: LQI >= 65. Scores below 55 for hired candidates should trigger a quality review. Track trend over quarters, not just absolute values.**

02

Dashboard 2

Employee Performance

4 KPIs in this dashboard

Average KPI Achievement

WHAT IS IT	The mean KPI_Achievement score across all employees and all quarters in the FactPerformanceTimeseries table. Expressed as a decimal (e.g. 0.72 = 72% of KPI target met).
WHY DOES IT MATTER	KPI achievement is the primary output measure of workforce productivity. It reveals whether employees are meeting organisational performance expectations and tracks whether performance improves, plateaus, or declines over tenure.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If average falls below 0.65, investigate whether targets are unrealistic, managers are providing insufficient support, or onboarding is failing to prepare employees adequately. Segment by department and tenure to identify where underperformance concentrates.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 0.70 (70% of KPI target). High-performing organisations typically average 0.75-0.85. Below 0.60 is a performance crisis threshold.**

Average Quality of Work

WHAT IS IT	The mean Quality_of_Work score across all performance records. This is a subjective-to-objective composite score (0-1 scale) rating the standard of output produced, independent of quantity or target achievement.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	KPI achievement measures whether targets are hit; Quality of Work measures how well the work is done. An employee can hit a sales target through poor practices that damage client relationships — quality captures what KPI alone misses.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Departments with high KPI achievement but low quality scores suggest a 'hit the number at any cost' culture. Introduce quality review checkpoints and ensure manager feedback loops address quality alongside targets.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 0.70. Scores below 0.60 signal a systemic quality issue. Monitor alongside KPI Achievement — divergence between the two is a leading indicator of future churn.**

Average Skill Acquisition Score

WHAT IS IT	The mean Skill_Acquisition_Score across all quarterly performance records. Measures the rate at which employees are developing new competencies over their tenure.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Skill acquisition is a leading indicator of future performance and retention. Employees who are not growing their skills become disengaged and at higher attrition risk. It also measures the ROI of training and development investment.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If skill scores plateau after Q4-Q6 of tenure, learning programmes may be insufficiently challenging for experienced employees. Introduce advanced tracks or stretch assignments for employees beyond 18 months tenure.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 0.60, with a positive trend across tenure quarters. A flat or declining trend after quarter 8 warrants an L&D; programme review.**

Top Performing Department

WHAT IS IT	The department with the highest average KPI_Achievement score across all its employees and all recorded quarters. Displayed as a single department name with its average score.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Identifying the top-performing department allows leadership to study and replicate what is working — management practices, team composition, role clarity, or incentive structures that are driving superior results.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Conduct a best-practice audit of the top department. Document what differentiates it (manager profile, team structure, onboarding approach) and use findings to create a playbook for underperforming departments.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**The top department should consistently achieve >= 0.75 KPI average. If no department reaches 0.70, the issue is systemic rather than departmental.**

03

Dashboard 3

Employee Lifecycle & Retention

4 KPIs in this dashboard

Overall Attrition Rate (%)

WHAT IS IT	The percentage of employees whose Employment_Status is 'Terminated' out of the total employee headcount. Calculated as (Terminated employees / Total employees) x 100.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Attrition is one of the most expensive HR metrics — replacing an employee typically costs 50-200% of their annual salary when recruiting, onboarding, and lost productivity are factored in. High attrition signals systemic issues with engagement, management, compensation, or culture.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If attrition exceeds 20%, launch an immediate root cause analysis using exit reason data. Segment by department, tenure band, and manager to identify whether the problem is concentrated or widespread.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: below 15% annually. 10-12% is considered healthy natural turnover. Above 20% is a retention crisis requiring executive intervention.**

Average Tenure (Months)

WHAT IS IT	The mean Total_Tenure_Months across all employees in the FactLifecycleRetention table, including both active and terminated employees.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Average tenure reflects whether the organisation retains people long enough to recoup their hiring and onboarding investment (typically 6-18 months). Short average tenure amplifies recruitment costs and reduces institutional knowledge.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If average tenure is below 18 months, investigate whether onboarding is failing (high early attrition in 0-6 month band) or whether mid-career engagement drops off (high attrition in 12-36 month band). Target interventions differently for each.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 30 months average tenure. Below 18 months signals critical early attrition. Segment by role level — executive tenure averaging below 24 months is particularly high-risk.**

Average Attrition Risk Score

WHAT IS IT	The mean Attrition_Risk_Score across all employees. This is a predictive model score (0-100) indicating the likelihood that an employee will voluntarily leave within the next period.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Attrition risk is a leading indicator — it predicts future turnover before it happens, allowing proactive intervention. Average risk score tracks whether the workforce is becoming more or less stable over time as HR interventions take effect.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Flag all employees scoring above 70 for immediate manager check-in and retention conversation. Employees scoring 55-70 should be enrolled in engagement programmes. Track whether interventions cause scores to drop in subsequent periods.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: average score below 45. Average above 55 indicates the workforce is broadly at risk. Individual scores above 70 require immediate action.**

Average Compensation vs Market

WHAT IS IT	The mean Comp_vs_Market value across all employees. A negative value means employees are paid below market rate on average; positive means above. Expressed as a decimal ratio (e.g. -0.05 = 5% below market).
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Compensation is consistently cited as a top reason for voluntary attrition. Being below market even by 5-10% significantly increases turnover probability, particularly for high performers who have more outside options.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If the average is negative (below market), conduct an immediate compensation benchmarking review. Prioritise salary adjustments for high-LQI employees and those with high attrition risk scores — they are most likely to be poached.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: 0.00 to +0.05 (at or slightly above market). Below -0.05 is a retention risk. Below -0.10 is a compensation crisis requiring urgent budget reallocation.**

04

Dashboard 4

Employee Pulse & Engagement

4 KPIs in this dashboard

Average Monthly Pulse Score

WHAT IS IT	The mean Monthly_Pulse_Score across all employees and all recorded pulse periods. Pulse scores are collected monthly and reflect employee sentiment, wellbeing, and engagement on a 0-100 scale.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Pulse scores are a real-time engagement barometer. Unlike annual engagement surveys, monthly pulse data catches deterioration early — a declining pulse score typically precedes increased attrition by 2-3 months, making it one of the most actionable leading indicators available.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If the average drops more than 5 points month-over-month, trigger a rapid listening session or pulse follow-up to identify causes. Do not wait for the annual survey cycle — by then, affected employees may have already resigned.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 75. Scores below 65 indicate widespread disengagement. A drop of more than 8 points in a single month (as seen in the data around late 2020) warrants an immediate leadership response.**

% Employees in High Culture Band

WHAT IS IT	The percentage of total pulse records where Culture_Band = 'High', indicating the employee reported strong cultural alignment and engagement in that period.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Cultural fit is a strong predictor of both performance and retention. A high proportion of employees in the High culture band indicates the organisation's values, working environment, and team dynamics are resonating with the workforce.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	If this percentage is declining, investigate whether recent organisational changes (restructures, leadership changes, policy shifts) have disrupted cultural cohesion. Segment by department to find where culture is weakest.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: >= 55% in High band. Below 40% indicates a culture problem. Monitor the Low band percentage separately — above 20% Low is a critical signal.**

Lowest Pulse Score Month

WHAT IS IT	The calendar month with the lowest average Monthly_Pulse_Score across all employees. Displayed as a month-year label with the corresponding score.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Identifying the lowest-ever pulse period allows the organisation to retrospectively understand what drove the engagement dip — external events, internal changes, or seasonal factors — and prepare mitigation strategies if similar conditions recur.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Research what happened in and around that month. Was there a major business event (redundancies, restructure, leadership change)? Use the finding to build an early warning protocol so future similar events trigger proactive engagement support.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Any month where average pulse falls below 65 should be formally reviewed. A month below 60 constitutes a workforce engagement crisis and should be documented as a case study for future risk management.**

Average Pulse Score by Department

WHAT IS IT	The mean Monthly_Pulse_Score broken down by Department from DimEmployee. Shows which departments have the most and least engaged employees on average.
WHY DOES IT MATTER	Department-level pulse variation reveals whether engagement issues are organisation-wide or concentrated in specific teams. A department consistently below the organisation average signals localised problems — often manager-related — that can be addressed without organisation-wide initiatives.
ACTION IT SHOULD DRIVE	Departments scoring more than 8 points below the organisational average should be prioritised for manager coaching, skip-level conversations, and tailored engagement interventions. Pair low-scoring departments with high-scoring counterparts for best-practice sharing.
BENCHMARK / TARGET	**Target: no department more than 10 points below the organisational average. Variation above 15 points between highest and lowest department indicates a structural management quality problem.**

Quick Reference Summary

KPI	Dashboard	Target / Benchmark
Avg Days to Fill	**Recruitment**	**< 40 days**
Avg Total Acquisition Cost	**Recruitment**	**< $5,000 per hire**
Hire Rate (%)	**Recruitment**	**25 – 40%**
Avg LQI of Hired Candidates	**Recruitment**	**>= 65**
Avg KPI Achievement	**Performance**	**>= 0.70 (70%)**
Avg Quality of Work	**Performance**	**>= 0.70**
Avg Skill Acquisition Score	**Performance**	**>= 0.60, positive trend**
Top Performing Department	**Performance**	**>= 0.75 dept avg KPI**
Overall Attrition Rate (%)	**Lifecycle**	**< 15% annually**
Avg Tenure (Months)	**Lifecycle**	**>= 30 months**
Avg Attrition Risk Score	**Lifecycle**	**< 45 average**
Avg Compensation vs Market	**Lifecycle**	**0.00 to +0.05**
Avg Monthly Pulse Score	**Pulse**	**>= 75**
% High Culture Band	**Pulse**	**>= 55%**
Lowest Pulse Score Month	**Pulse**	**No month < 65**
Avg Pulse Score by Department	**Pulse**	**No dept > 10pts below avg**